which mother love was considered obscene. Fortunately, Horace had taken it, and at a new high rate of $.04 a word.

In addition, Fred had sold "Button, Button" to Thrilling Wonder at $.015 a word. (That was more like the old days.)

At about that time, too, I got Howard Browne's new magazine Fantastic. It did indeed look very classy and he had obviously gotten the publishers of Amazing to take a chance on quality. That first issue —Summer 1952—had my story "What if—?" 5 in it.

Unfortunately, the magazine didn't last. It went five issues and was then combined with Fantastic Adventures. Too bad.

Finally, I received my first copies of Foundation and Empire.

20

On August 8, 1952, I had owned my car for two years and had just paid the final installment. It was mine outright now, and I had eighteen thousand miles on it.

As for David, he now had six teeth, was thirty inches tall, and weighed twenty-one pounds. On August 9, we took the giant step of hiring a baby-sitter to stay with him while we went off visiting. We came back to find David perfectly safe and happy.

21

I finally got a copy of Ich, der Robot, and even before that, Gotthard Guenther arrived on August 11 with a German-language anthology called Verwindung von Raum and Zeit (Transcendence of Space and Time). The second story it contained was "Einbruch der Nacht" ("Nightfall").

In Ich, der Robot I couldn't help but notice that all my characters spoke perfect German even though they were named Michael Dono-

5 See Nightfall and Other Stories.

van, Gregory Powell, Susan Calvin, and so on. I asked Gotthard why they didn't translate the names, too, and have a Max Donnerheit, a Gustav Pommern, and a Sieglinde Kaspar.